

UNIT 6

What a waste!

If people re-use plastic bags, how much cheaper will the things they buy cost?

How long can glass last if you don't break it up?

If we put an aluminum can in the ground, how long will it take to break down?

The average person in Greece uses about 250kg of paper each year. If we recycle this paper, how many trees do we save?

Which item makes up the largest amount of our house rubbish?

These children from around the world want to know some things about waste and the environment. Try to guess the answers to their questions. You can check the answers by doing the first Grammar activity on page 63.

Grammar:

Zero conditional, First conditional
Unless + first conditional = if not

Functions:

Stating a fact;
making statements about possible future situations

Vocabulary:

Pollutants, waste and recycling

Learning strategies:

When I study a written text, I...

- use my world knowledge to guess facts
- read texts in Greek to help me understand the concepts of the topic in the unit
- use the grammar in the lesson to test hypotheses
- use it for ideas to make my own suggestions.

Lesson 1

AIMS

- To teach the first and zero conditionals
- To teach 'unless'
- To predict key points of information in a text
- To find solutions in a text

Lead-in Task 1

What kinds of things do you and your family throw away? Write down six things and then compare your answers with your partner. Who do you think throws away the most rubbish in your family? Why do they do this? Discuss your ideas with your partner.

Look at the words in the box. How many of these items have you got on your list?

old tyres	boots	traffic cones	dolls	plastic bags	magazines
cans	bottles	umbrellas	old pieces of wood		plastic containers

1. *Where do you and your family put the old things that you don't use anymore?*
2. *How do you feel when you see litter like old cans, bottles, plastic and paper, on beaches and in the countryside? Why?*
3. *What do you do if you see someone dropping litter in the street or on the beach?*

Task 2

Look at the picture below. In pairs, find ten examples of things that people throw away in public places like rivers.

Make a list of the consequences from this behaviour.

Use the Internet to find examples of rivers which suffer from this kind of behaviour.

What a load of rubbish!





Grammar

Zero conditional

Look at the pictures below to help you match 1-5 with a-e and say what happens in each of the situations.



A.



B.



C.



D.



E.

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---|
| 1. If we recycle paper | a) we see that most of it is paper |
| 2. If we reuse our plastic bags | b) it takes a million years to decompose |
| 3. If we examine our waste, | c) we save 1,000 trees a day |
| 4. If we throw away cans, | d) it takes 300 years for them to decompose |
| 5. If we don't break up glass | e) we save 5 cents on our shopping bill. |

First conditional

In pairs, use the pictures a-e to help you think of an answer to each of the questions:



A.



B.



C.



D.



E.

- What will happen if we don't clean the beaches?
- What will happen if the headmaster sees you dropping litter in the school?
- What will happen if we don't recycle?
- What will happen if we throw plastic bags in the streets?
- What will happen if we dump our junk like old wood and metal in the countryside?

Unless

Look at the two example sentences. In pairs, underline the word which means 'if not'.

I can't have a school party unless the classroom is clean.
Unless I tidy my room, my mum won't let me go out.

Lesson 1



Conditional sentences

Zero Conditional:

If + Present → Present / Imperative

Unless + Present → Present

We use *Zero Conditional* to state a fact or a truth, and to give instructions.

First Conditional:

If + Present → will + infinitive

Unless + Present → will + infinitive

We use *First Conditional* to state or predict the future result of a present action.

Task 1

Match the grammatical form to the sentences below.

- We will live in a rubbish dump unless we recycle now.
- If you see litter on the street, pick it up and throw it in a rubbish bin.
- If we recycle today, the world will be a cleaner place tomorrow.
- If I eat an ice cream, I put the wrapping in the bin.

Task 2

Read the information and answer the questions in bold.

A. We use if + present to talk about possibilities in the future and their results

If + present tense → will + infinitive

Example: If we put our litter in the bin, the school yard will be clean.

What will happen if we don't put our litter in the bin?

B. We use if + present → present to talk about a fact or to give instructions.

If + present tense → present tense

Example: If you want more advice about recycling, ring our hotline 801 11 11111

What do you do to get more information?



Reading Pre-reading

Task 1

The three teenagers below wrote letters to the local newspapers about problems caused by pollution and litter that exist in the area where they live.

In pairs, match the following statements according to the titles of these Greek newspapers.

- Unless the new Mayor succeeds in his effort to restore the original architecture, the city will suffer.
- Supermarkets and other shops will have to pay a huge fine if they dump their rubbish in the streets.
- Many people will become ill and die if infected mosquitoes bite them.

A **Επιδημία δάγκειου πυρετού**

Θύμα του η νοτιοανατολική Ασία και «ένοχες» η ασυφιλία και η μετανάστευση...

B **Τα Τίρανα πληρώνουν το τίμημα της περιβαλλοντολογικής ελευθερίας**

C **Μεγάλα πρόστιμα για τα σκουπίδια επιβάλλει ο Δήμος Αθηναίων**

Task 2

Do you think the following statements are true or false? Why?

- i) The Albanian government will not allow people in Tirana to use cars.
- ii) The Albanian government will encourage people to throw away their old cars.
- iii) There are clean toilets and washing areas in the Gypsy camps in Aspropirgos.
- iv) You will pay 50 Yuan if a policeman sees you throwing rubbish in the street in Beijing.
- v) People in Beijing will change their habits because of the Olympic Games.

Task 3

Read these 3 letters quickly to check if you are right. Then read the texts again and the possible solutions for each problem more carefully. In pairs, discuss the three solutions and then decide which you think the best solution for each problem is.

A. I'm called Agnieska and I live in the centre of Tirana. Some days on my way to school the smoke from the cars makes me feel dizzy and sick. It sounds incredible but in the 1980's there were only 2000 cars in Tirana. Now there are 300,000 and most of them are in the city centre each day. Unless the government does something about the smoke and the smog, many people will have breathing problems. The result is terrible air pollution and some times during the day the air is so full of dirty smoke that we can't breathe. This is absolutely terrible and according to the European environment agency, traffic in Tirana produces 50 kilograms of pollution for every Albanian each year. What people do not realize is that lead in fuel causes a decrease in intelligence and if the government does not test to see if this is the case with children in Tirana, the children will have problems in school. The mayor says that, if necessary, he will stop people driving old cars and make drivers pay fines if their car creates pollution. I quite like this idea and I think it will work. **Solutions: a) get newer cars b) ask the European environment agency for help, c) test children to see how much lead they have.**

B. I'm Marios and I live near the town of Aspropirgos outside Athens. There is a camp of Gypsies near us. The people who live there have to live under terrible conditions. For example, there is nowhere for them to put their rubbish and so it piles up. Some people throw litter out of laziness but others do it because there are no bins. There is so much waste like empty cans of coke, packets of crisps and other waste that even with a light breeze all the litter blows everywhere. There are no proper bathrooms or places to wash themselves and many children get ill. Over a period of time, this will get worse. It's a crying shame to see this in our country. If you walk around the camp, you see all kinds of things like empty tubes of toothpaste or old bars of soap lying on the ground. Sometimes when it rains the drains get blocked and the camp floods making the place a mess. Do the mayor and government not understand that people get ill if where they live is dirty? He even says that the people in the camps will have to pay a fine if they don't clean up the rubbish. This is not right and local people should write to the government or environmental organization and ask them for support. **Solutions: a) build a better camp, b) get the government to build bathrooms, c) encourage people in the area to take action to help.**

C. My name is Deng and I come from China. I live in Beijing, which is a city of over 15 million people. Just before dawn each morning, the streets are clean but by the end of the day there is enough litter to fill an Olympic sized swimming pool! Because of the Olympic Games in 2008 the government wants to make the city clean and it is trying to encourage people to change their bad habits and to be more responsible for their rubbish. Now it is a crime to throw rubbish or litter in the street. For example, if you drop litter or throw cigarette butts on the road, the police can fine you 500 Yuan on-the-spot. Although this is a good idea and they do it to help, I don't think it will change anything. In a big city people always think someone else will clean up the mess. This is a disgrace. They don't understand that it is everyone's responsibility to keep their city clean. Unless people learn to respect where they live, nothing will change and the problem will remain the same. We need to educate people about the importance of living in a clean environment. After all, it's for their own good, so why don't people want to change their bad habits? **Solutions: a) make people pay a fine if they throw litter in the street, b) tell people to stop producing rubbish, c) teach people about the importance of keeping their city clean.**

Task 4 *Which child i) lives in a city which is bigger than Athens; ii) wants the government to help solve the problems; iii) likes the idea of fines; iv) talks about children in schools?*

Lesson 2

AIMS

- To follow a sequence of instructions
- To express your opinion in letters

Lead-in

Task 1

In pairs, look through the Reading texts on page 65 and find 3 negative phrases which show how the children feel about the situation.

Task 2

Complete the sentences using the following words: loaf, slice, can, carton, packet, tube, bar. Then use the ideas in the statements to make an anti-litter slogan for a poster to keep the school tidy.



1. Don't use chemicals! Buy a natural of soap on-line.
2. The fluoride in your of toothpaste may not be healthy.
3. When you finish eating your of crisps, put the bag into the rubbish bin.
4. You can use your empty of milk to make cardboard items like small toys.
5. At the bakery, a fresh of bread doesn't have a plastic wrapping.
6. Reuse your empty of coke to make a pencil holder for your desk.
7. Don't throw that of cheese on the ground. It will attract mice.

Pre-listening

Look at the picture. What does the man have in his hands? What do you think he is doing? What kind of TV show do you think this is?

- a) a show for adults
- a) a show for old ladies
- a) a show for young people





Listening

You are going to listen to a radio programme with someone explaining how to reuse old things that we have around the house.

Task 1

A. Which items in list A does the speaker mention. Tick the boxes.

List A

- Toothpaste tubes ☐
- Aluminium cans ☐
- Margarine tubs ☐
- Cereal packets ☐
- Shoe boxes ☐
- Plastic bags ☐

List B

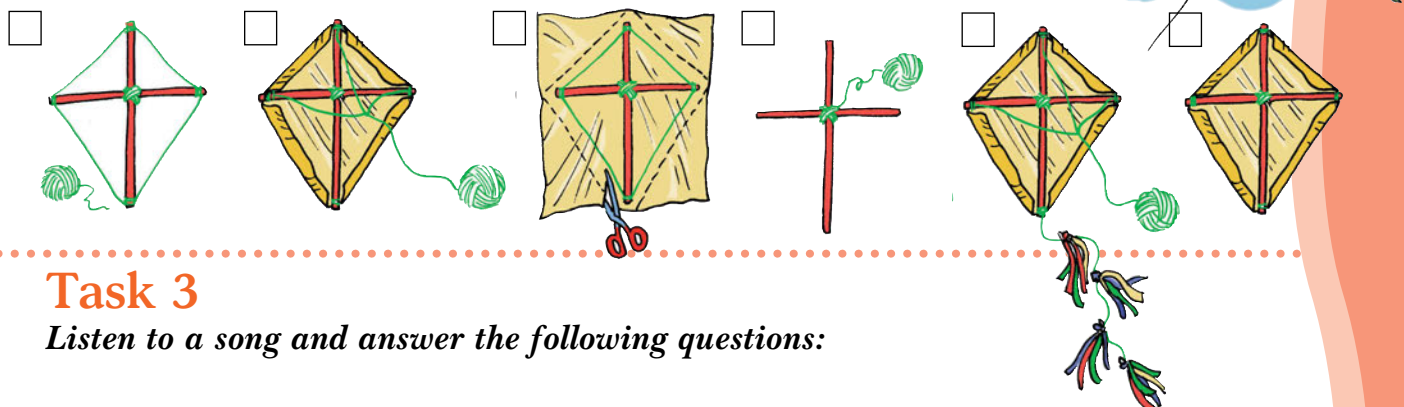
- a jar ☐
- candle holders ☐
- a mask ☐
- box files ☐
- a kite ☐
- a book cover ☐



B. 'Be an Artist': Which two things in list B can you make with the materials in list A? Tick the boxes. Which of the things can you see in this recycled item from rubbish in the opposite picture?

Task 2

You are going to listen to the second part of the programme about making a kite from an old plastic bag. Listen and put the pictures 1-6 in the right order.



Task 3

Listen to a song and answer the following questions:

A. Listen to the song and tick the correct title.

- Don't Dream! ☐
- Dream Time! ☐
- Only a Dream! ☐

B. Discuss your answer with the class.

What is the message in the song? Will it be an effective message to get people to stop throwing litter? Why? Why not?



Lesson 3

Task 1



Speaking

THE NEWS

i) Winter is coming, clean up all the rubbish in your area.

ii) Any solutions for the cardboard mountains?

People continue to chuck out boxes and cartons.

iii) Air pollution in our city is really terrible.

People can hardly breathe.

iv) How do we save paper at school?

The paper waste is a worry for all. We need to act now!

v) Tourists leave litter on beach!

The main reason is that there are no bins for people to put their rubbish!

In pairs, read the newspaper titles and think about what you can do to help. Match the titles to the responses.

- Yes, and if we don't do something about it, people will have breathing problems.
- Good idea! If we don't, the drains will block and we'll have floods.
- If the Town council puts more bins, the problem will stop.
- Well, if we use the two sides of every page of paper, that's a start.
- If people buy presents without wrapping, that'll help.

Task 2

A) Greece has an excellent record in environmental protection and people want this to continue. To help in this aim, an environmental group in Greece wants to make a poster with these photographs below. In pairs discuss the environmental problem each picture shows from other parts of the world. Then write a sentence for each picture saying what you think will happen if we are not careful with our own country.



- Look at the environmental organization titles and logos and match the organization to what they do.
- In pairs, choose one of the problems that you want to support. You want to contact an international organization for information. Which organization will you contact?

Task 3

Problem - give the man solutions

A man has got some old rubbish in his yard. He has bottles, old tomatoes and cardboard boxes. He lives in a block of flats near the centre of the town. He is thinking of different solutions like:

- burning everything
- leaving it in a pile in the corner of his balcony
- reusing everything

What will the results or consequences be? Use the example to make correct sentences.

Example:

If he /try to burn/ the glass / not burn.

If he tries to burn the glass, it won't burn

- If he /burn/ the boxes / a lot of smoke
- If he /leave / the tomatoes / smell
- If he / not clean / the rubbish / neighbours complain
- If he leave / boxes / attract mice
- If he reuse/ the boxes / store other things
- If he / reuse/ the bottles / create a piece of art
- If he throw/ tomatoes / in garden / help the soil

Recycling as art



Task 4

Complete the diagram below with waste items in the right bin.



GLASS	PLASTIC	PAPER/CARDBOARD	METAL
Bottles	containers		
		books	computers

Recycling - Pre writing

Task 1

Look at the photograph. Is there one of these bins near your house?
What does the poster tell people to do with their rubbish?
How does recycling help the environment?
What other advantages does recycling offer the local council?



Task 2

In pairs, look at the facts on recycling and decide what we **SHOULD** do to help the environment. What will the results be if we don't? Try to use 'if' and 'unless' in your statements.

FACT

More than half the paper and cardboard in the UK is made from recycled paper

FACT

Life in water is often most strongly affected because water spreads pollution easily and because we often dump our waste in water

FACT

The human race drinks six hundred million cans of coke a day! If an empty can weighs 2 grams, think of how many thousands of kilos that is each day.

FACT

Making an aluminium can from recycled material uses one twentieth of the energy needed to make a new can

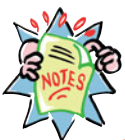
FACT

People in the UK recycle ten times more glass today than 5 years ago and the cost of drink in bottles is lower.

FACT

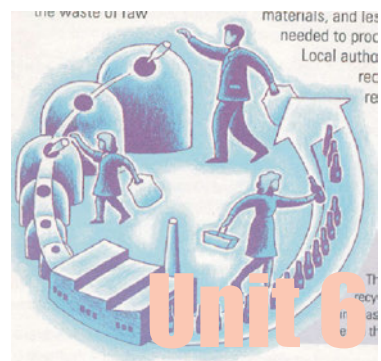
Less pollution is not only good for wildlife and nature - human health benefits from less pollution as well.

That means lower medical bills, and a better quality of life.



Writing Task 3

An English-speaking friend is thinking of starting a recycling club in the area where s/he lives. Your friend wants to know if it is a good idea. Look at the leaflet and write a letter to give your opinion.



Unit 6

Lesson 3

Recycling as art



Project Task 1

Your class wants to get involved in the campaign to make people aware of the dangers our planet faces. Look at the pictures of environmental issues in different parts of the world, and a recycling idea. Decide as a group which idea you think will be most helpful. Decide in your group the roles you need to create an awareness campaign.



Example: • The Aral Sea will disappear. (See relevant site on page 190)

- You can recycle wherever you are; at home, school or outside. If each of us recycles, we can make a difference to our world.



Task 2



In the listening lesson, you heard about using old rubbish to create art. Look at this picture from the site: www.ecoart.gr. Discuss as a group the things the artist used to create a piece of art.



Imagine an English-speaking friend of yours wants to start creating art from junk. Write a short note to your friend telling him/her what you know about this kind of art (you can get ideas online at www.ecoart.gr or www.johndahlsen.com). In pairs, decide what the steps to follow are to create a piece of art from waste and junk.



Make your own work of eco-art.

- Step 1:
Step 2:
Step 3:
Step 4:
Step 5:
Step 6:

Self-evaluation

Activity A

Find the missing words about the environment for sentences 1-8 in the word square. The first letter of each word is given.

1. If you want to help the planet r..... as much as you can.
2. Unless we reduce the p..... we create, the world will face problems.
3. Another word for things we throw out is w.....
4. Each house in Greece throws out a hundred kilos of r..... each month.
5. If school kids put their l..... in the bins, the schools will be cleaner.
6. The Town Council collects all the old j..... people throw in the streets.
7. It is important to keep our e..... clean.
8. After the heavy rain, the camp was a real m..... with litter and cans everywhere.

F	A	D	E	A	L	M	B	N	F	L	A
A	H	U	B	C	H	G	H	D	O	I	T
E	N	V	I	R	O	N	M	E	N	T	A
E	F	A	P	E	D	O	E	L	P	T	W
O	P	D	B	C	W	A	S	T	E	E	G
C	F	A	C	Y	D	I	S	L	F	R	S
D	R	I	G	C	J	U	N	K	R	U	A
A	P	O	L	L	U	T	I	O	N	E	T
E	F	I	B	E	R	U	B	B	I	S	H
C	H	A	D	L	F	A	C	S	F	A	S

___/4 points

Activity B

Put the verbs in brackets into the correct form.

- a) We (have) mountains of rubbish unless people become responsible for their environment.
- b) If you want information about recycling, (ring) 801 11 111111
- c) If someone (pollute) the environment, the police (fine) him.
- d) Unless we all do something soon, the world (suffer)..... from pollution.
- e) People don't care about a problem unless it (affect) their lives.

___/6 points

Activity C

Complete the following sentences with one of the words from the box.

dawn

time

centre

good

laziness

- i) She threw the wrapping on the ground out of
- ii) The worst pollution is in the city
- iii) The problem of pollution will get worse over a period of
- iv) People need to understand that a clean environment is for their own
- v) There is no smoke or smog in the air just before

___/2.5 points



Self-evaluation

Activity D

Words connected with litter.

Find the words connected with rubbish in the word-snake which are similar in meaning to the explanations in a-j.

bagstyrespapertinsbulbmagazinewrappingcanscardboardcontainer

- a. What we put around a present
- b. What lights a room
- c. Where you find tomato sauce
- d. Soft drinks come in these
- e. Where you can put food for the fridge
- f. A hard material made of paper
- g. What you write a letter on
- h. These are on the wheels of your bicycle
- i. The supermarket puts food into these
- j. Your aunt probably reads one of these each month

___/5 points

Activity E

Match the verbs on the left with the words on the right.

- | | |
|------------|------------|
| i) educate | a) clean |
| ii) drop | b) people |
| iii) keep | c) respect |
| iv) change | d) litter |
| v) learn | e) habits |

___/2.5 points

Now tick how well you can do the following :

	With difficulty	Quite well	Easily
✓ I can read a text and decide on a solution	☐	☐	☐
✓ I can listen to a radio programme and follow instructions	☐	☐	☐
✓ I can talk about the threat of pollution to our environment	☐	☐	☐
✓ I can write a letter to express my opinion	☐	☐	☐